

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



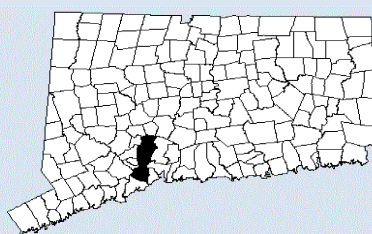
Regional School District 05

Jennifer Byars, Superintendent • 203-397-4811 • <http://www.amityregion5.org>

District Information

Grade Range	7-12
Number of Schools/Programs	7
Enrollment	2,112
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$22,558
Total Expenditures ¹	\$47,484,143

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	1,098	52.0	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	307	14.5	5.2
Black or African American	*	*	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	201	9.5	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	88	4.2	4.7
White	1,433	67.9	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	30	1.4	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	302	14.3	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	279	13.2	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	72	7.1	28	2.7
Male	*	*	72	6.4
Non-Binary	*	*	0	*
Black or African American	7	9.2	8	10.0
Hispanic or Latino of any race	22	10.5	21	9.8
White	95	6.7	65	4.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	48	13.8	36	9.3
Students with Disabilities	46	16.7	29	9.8
District	141	6.7	100	4.7
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 145

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	159.4
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	10.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	23.9
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	29.6
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	9.5
School Level	11.2
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	6.0
Support Staff	2.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	6.5
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	23.0
School Nurses	5.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	156.5

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	5	2.1	1.4
Black or African American	6	2.5	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	5	2.1	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	225	93.4	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	12.6	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	9	*	11	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	28	82.4	21	95.5
White	200	90.1	248	94.7
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	45	88.2	51	91.1
Students with Disabilities	23	79.3	55	93.2
District	296	90.0	351	95.6
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	25	49.0
Emotional Disability	22	71.0
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	83	85.6
Other Health Impairment	68	97.1
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	8	*
District	209	72.6
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	51	2.4	2.6
Emotional Disability	31	1.5	1.1
Intellectual Disability	11	0.5	0.6
Learning Disability	97	4.5	6.4
Other Health Impairment	70	3.3	3.5
Other Disabilities	17	0.8	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	11	0.5	2.0
All Disabilities	288	13.5	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	13	4.5	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	14	4.9	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$24,738,767	\$11,752	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$5,467,593	\$2,650	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$2,160,407	\$1,047	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$1,757,367	\$852	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$3,653,853	\$1,771	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$1,188,871	\$576	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$3,668,404	\$1,778	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$3,570,046	\$1,772	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$1,278,836	\$620	\$213
Total	\$47,484,143	\$22,558	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$3,386,868	36.2	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$757,482	8.1	10.2
Other Salaries	.	.	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$810,887	8.7	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$1,046,534	11.2	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$1,992,623	21.3	22.2
Supplies	\$54,832	0.6	0.7
Property Services	\$19,670	0.2	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$1,256,596	13.4	8.4
Equipment	\$24,287	0.3	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$2,863	0.0	0.1
Total	\$9,352,644	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		19.7	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	92.5
State	4.6
Federal	2.6
Tuition & Other	0.3

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Asian	143	84.7	143	86.8	95	79.9
Black or African American	*	*	*	*	23	54.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	102	68.4	102	66.0	73	66.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	47	82.0	47	79.2	28	72.1
White	692	73.7	691	70.3	456	67.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	38	62.7	38	62.8	12	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	983	75.2	982	72.4	663	69.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	153	64.8	153	63.0	92	58.4
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	868	76.5	867	73.6	583	70.4
Students with Disabilities	106	51.6	106	45.7	63	42.8
Students without Disabilities	915	77.4	914	75.1	612	71.4
High Needs	252	61.2	252	58.2	147	53.1
Non-High Needs	769	79.1	768	76.6	528	73.1
District	1,021	74.7	1,020	72.0	675	68.8

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	N/A	N/A	90.4	88.0	663	89.3
Curl Up	N/A	N/A	99.2	88.6	661	94.3
Push Up	N/A	N/A	92.3	83.9	661	88.4
Mile Run/PACER	N/A	N/A	84.0	68.3	659	76.6
All Tests - District	N/A	N/A	75.8	62.3	644	69.6
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	14	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	14	*
White	223	95.1
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	49	89.8
Students with Disabilities	41	73.2
District	320	95.9
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	199	60.7
Male	207	56.3
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	25	44.6
White	265	54.8
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	43	40.2
Students with Disabilities	8	9.1
District	406	58.3
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	88.2	94.3
Male	87.6	92.8
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	90.0
White	87.2	93.3
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	91.1	92.3
Students with Disabilities	70.3	81.5
District	87.9	93.6
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	74.7	75	49.8	50	99.6	63.9
	High Needs Students	61.2	75	40.8	50	81.7	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	72.0	75	48.0	50	96.0	60.2
	High Needs Students	58.2	75	38.8	50	77.6	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	68.8	75	45.9	50	91.7	61.8
	High Needs Students	53.1	75	35.4	50	70.8	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	61.3%	100%	61.3	100	61.3	58.7%
	High Needs Students	53.3%	100%	53.3	100	53.3	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	67.8%	100%	67.8	100	67.8	61.4%
	High Needs Students	61.0%	100%	61.0	100	61.0	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	75.9%	100%	38.0	50	75.9	58.9%
	Oral	74.6%	100%	37.3	50	74.6	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	6.7%	<=5%	46.7	50	93.3	17.7%
	High Needs Students	14.3%	<=5%	31.5	50	63.0	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	93.0%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	58.3%	75%	38.9	50	77.8	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		96.5%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		95.9%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		91.8%	94%	97.7	100	97.7	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		87.9%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		93.5% 69.6%	75%	46.4	50	92.8	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		62.1%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	55.0%
Accountability Index				1188.4	1450	82.0	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	61.2	13.8	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	75.0	58.2	16.8	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	73.1	53.1	20.1	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	91.8%	2.2%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.0
	High Needs Students	96.4
Math	All Students	97.9
	High Needs Students	96.4
Science	All Students	99.0
	High Needs Students	96.9

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: N/A State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The strategic plan of Amity Regional School District No. 5 underscores a central commitment to fostering the mental health and overall well-being of students. Professional learning initiatives prioritize the cultivation of trauma-informed instructional practices and the implementation of strategies geared towards bolstering social-emotional learning within the overall school setting. Staff received a series of professional learning sessions concentrated on building resilience, promoting mental wellness, and facilitating transformative social-emotional learning experiences throughout the academic year. To address truancy and chronic absenteeism, a committee of both administrators and teachers met throughout the year and implemented a multi-tiered set of strategies to manage these issues. A significant component of the committee's plan emphasized increasing family and community awareness and communications as student absences occur.

Students who are supported socially and emotionally are available for learning, and Amity's other district improvement focus was on setting high academic expectations. The STAR Assessment was administered to students in grades 7-8. All 9th, 10th, and 11th grade students participated in the PSAT and 10th grade students were given the Pre-ACT test. The District MTSS Committee provided guidance and direction to staff on identifying and supporting students in need of tiered intervention. Both district and school-based data teams met regularly this year to review state and district-wide assessment data to identify strengths and opportunities for improvement related to teaching and learning in the district. Academic focus on reading continues to be high priority with the third year of implementation of the Readers' Workshop model for grades 7 & 8 English and the approval of a newly revised curriculum to help further guide instruction. The district also offered students multiple opportunities to apply their learning in real word context through the Science Research Program, the Senior Service-Learning Projects, and Senior Interest Projects this spring.

The district continued its commitment to ensuring the extension of students learning from school into the home. For example, principals sent weekly newsletters; and grade-level Schoology pages were in place to share information with high school students and their families. Parents of students with special needs were invited to participate in Parent and Placement Team meetings, 504 meetings, or Student Study Team meetings. PowerSchool allowed parents and students easy access to attendance, schedules, and academic records. Schoology was used as learning management tools to support students unable to attend school. Each school also has an active Parent Teacher Student Organization. The Board of Education has added a district-wide newsletter to the various communications that were sent out from the district. The Board also hosted a series of Community Forums where district and building-based administrators met directly with parents and families to discuss major topics within the school system.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The Amity District continues to engage in numerous initiatives designed to reduce ethnic, economic, and racial isolation. The district fully supports the Open Choice Program, with 40 students participating in the 2023-24 school year. Amity staff continued their commitment to efforts around Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion. The District's DEI coach expanded work into community outreach by regularly attending town committee DEI meetings. The DEI coach routinely collaborated with teachers and administrators, supporting their efforts to promote inclusion and a sense of belonging among students and staff. During the 2023-2024 school year, the district developed a plan to increase educator diversity with the three feeder elementary school districts aiming to enhance staff diversity throughout the district. The district supported a group of teachers and administrators to attend a five-day workshop on equitable grading practices. Additionally, teachers and administrators attended the RESC Alliance's Igniting Change Conference as part of the ongoing commitment to enhancing cultural understanding and inclusive educator workforce. Aligned with professional learning on diverse populations and with guidance from the local RESC and the DEI coach, the social studies and English departments engaged in comprehensive curriculum review while incorporating the equity audit tool to review curricular resources. The Career and Technical Education, Visual and Performing Arts, and Physical Education and Health departments developed an equity audit tool to review curriculum resources. For the third year in a row each school continued their work with our "No Place for Hate" program. This student-led school climate program allows activities to be tailored to the needs of the school. The district developed and administered a comprehensive school climate survey. This work moved from consultant-supported to being completely organized and executed by district staff. Administrators and school climate teams analyzed the student, personnel, and parent survey data to inform the development of building and district school climate improvement plans or the 2024-2025 school year.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Amity Board of Education is committed to ensuring that the entire district receives comparable resources through a fiscally responsible budgeting process. Annually, building principals, department leaders, and central office administrators collaborate to develop a budget that reflects the needs and priorities of the district. Issues such as enrollment, improved student performance, curriculum revision, health and safety, student interest, special education, and capital improvements drive the budget. The administrative team works closely to prioritize requests in alignment with district and school goals. The Superintendent develops a proposed budget that is presented to the Amity Finance Committee (AFC). The AFC consists of members from the three communities served by the Amity District. The members review the Superintendent's request and suggest adjustments. The Superintendent and administrative team review the suggested adjustments and reallocate resources in an equitable manner. The Superintendent presents the proposed budget to the Board for approval. A Public Hearing is held prior to Board adoption and the budget is approved in each town via a Referendum Process.